Valor vs Paperclip

Vertical SDLC teammate or horizontal agent control plane?

April 2026

Governing Thought

They solve **different problems at different layers**.

Valor is a vertically integrated development teammate.

Paperclip is a horizontally integrated agent management layer.

Not competitive -- complementary.

What Are We Comparing?

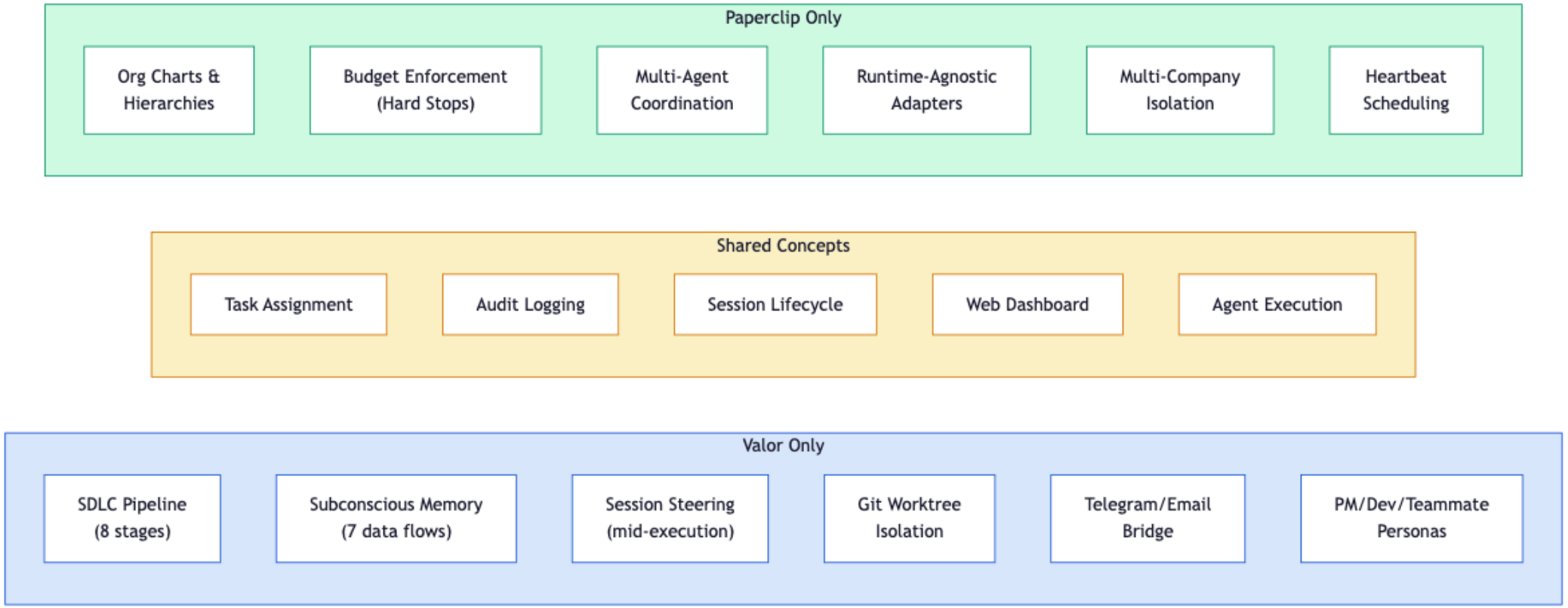
	VALOR AI SYSTEM	PAPERCLIP
Launched	2025 (private, iterative)	March 4, 2026 (open source)
What it is	SDLC automation system	Multi-agent control plane
Primary interface	Telegram, Email, CLI	React dashboard, REST API
How it works	PM/Dev/Teammate session orchestration	Heartbeat-scheduled agent coordination
Models	Claude (Sonnet, Haiku)	Any (adapter model)
Pricing	Claude API costs only	Free (MIT) + your infrastructure
Target user	Solo developer / small team	Multi-agent company operators
GitHub stars	Private repo	42,000+

Architecture: Vertical Stack vs Horizontal Layer

DIMENSION	VALOR	PAPERCLIP
Language	Python	TypeScript / Node.js
Database	Redis (Popoto ORM)	PostgreSQL
Process model	Bridge + Worker	Single Node.js server
Agent execution	Claude CLI harness	Adapter-dispatched heartbeats
Agent identity	PM / Dev / Teammate sessions	Org chart roles with job titles
Task model	8-stage SDLC pipeline with gates	Goal-aligned task hierarchy
Communication	Telegram, Email bridges	Task comments, tickets

Valor knows what a PR review is. Paperclip knows what an org chart is. Neither replaces the other.

Feature Comparison



Overlap is narrow: task assignment, audit logging, session lifecycle, dashboards. The unique capabilities point in opposite directions.

SDLC Pipeline: Valor's Domain Expertise

STAGE	VALOR	PAPERCLIP
Plan	/do-plan with investigation, spike resolution	Generic task creation
Critique	Parallel war-room critics	N/A
Build	Dev session with worktree isolation	Via agent adapter
Test	/do-test with parallel dispatch	Via agent adapter
Patch	Loop-back on failure, transcript resume	N/A
Review	/do-pr-review with screenshots	N/A
Docs	/do-docs with semantic impact finder	N/A
Merge	Gate enforcement, post-merge learning	N/A

Paperclip tasks are check-in/check-out. Valor stages have **loop-back**, **gate enforcement**, and **quality escalation**.

Memory and Learning

CAPABILITY	VALOR	PAPERCLIP
Memory retrieval	BM25 + RRF fusion, bloom filter	None
Stealth injection	`<thought>` blocks via additionalContext	N/A
Post-session extraction	Haiku categorization (4 types)	N/A
Outcome detection	LLM-judged acted/dismissed	N/A
Dismissal decay	Importance * 0.7 after 3 dismissals	N/A
Knowledge indexing	Per-chunk embeddings, work-vault	N/A
Post-merge learning	PR takeaway extraction (importance 7.0)	N/A

Valor's memory system is its **strongest differentiator**. Paperclip has no memory or learning -- agents bring their own.

Governance and Budget Control

CAPABILITY	VALOR	PAPERCLIP
Budget enforcement	None	Per-agent monthly limits, 80% warn, 100% stop
Approval gates	PM read-only hooks	Board-level approval workflow
Audit trail	Correlation IDs, session events	Append-only immutable log
Multi-tenant	Single operator	Multi-company isolation
Config safety	Git versioning	Versioned config with rollback
Cost visibility	Per-session model selection	Per-agent/task/project/goal breakdown

Governance is **Paperclip's strongest differentiator**. Valor has no budget enforcement or approval workflow.

Session Management

ASPECT	VALOR	PAPERCLIP
Lifecycle states	11 states with CAS conflict detection	Task checkout / heartbeat cycle
Recovery	8 mechanisms, zombie detection, stale cleanup	Checkpoint-based (basic)
Steering	Mid-execution Redis message injection	Not documented
Concurrency	Global semaphore + worker-key serialization	Single-assignee atomic checkout
Resume	Transcript resume via session UUID	Context reload per heartbeat
Parent-child	PM spawns Dev, tracks hierarchy	Org chart hierarchy

Valor sessions are **long-running and steerable**. Paperclip sessions are **periodic and stateless**.

OpenClaw: The Third Piece

ASPECT	VALOR	OPENCLAW	PAPERCLIP
Focus	SDLC	Autonomous agent	Orchestration
Agents	PM/Dev/Teammate	1 per instance	Many, any type
Memory	7 flows, BM25+RRF	Pluggable backends	None
Comms	Telegram, Email	Telegram, WhatsApp, Discord	Task comments
Governance	PM hooks	Self-directed	Board control
License	Private	Open source	MIT

Canonical AI company stack: Paperclip (control plane) + OpenClaw (customer-facing agents) + Valor (software development). Each plays a distinct role.

Integration Assessment

OPTION	EFFORT	VALUE	TIMING
A: Paperclip governs Valor	High -- custom adapter needed	Multi-project budget visibility, approval gates	When managing 5+ projects
B: Adopt Paperclip patterns	Medium -- extend PM hooks	Budget enforcement, goal tracing, audit log	Now
C: Wait and monitor	None	Avoid early-adopter pain	Default

Recommended: Option B now, Option A later.

Cherry-pick: budget enforcement, goal-aligned tracing, immutable audit log. Build natively in Valor's PM session architecture.

Decision Matrix

CRITERION	WEIGHT	VALOR	PAPERCLIP
SDLC capability	25%	**10**	1
Memory / learning	20%	**10**	0
Multi-agent coordination	15%	3	**9**
Budget governance	10%	1	**9**
Session management	10%	**9**	5
Ecosystem breadth	10%	4	**8**
Maturity	10%	**8**	3
Weighted total		**7.2**	**4.2**

For SDLC automation: Valor. For multi-agent orchestration: Paperclip. For both: use both.

What to Watch

- **Paperclip adapter ecosystem** -- a Claude Code adapter would lower integration cost
- **Clipmart templates** -- pre-built company templates for rapid adoption
- **OpenClaw + Paperclip** -- the reference "agent inside control plane" pattern
- **Anthropic Managed Agents** -- may gain org features that overlap with Paperclip
- **Regulatory environment** -- "zero-human company" framing attracts scrutiny

> *Paperclip is 6 weeks old and growing fast. The adapter ecosystem will determine whether integration is worth the engineering cost or whether adopting its patterns natively is the better path.*

Summary

Valor = deep, vertical, SDLC-native, memory-rich

Paperclip = broad, horizontal, governance-first, runtime-agnostic

Action: Adopt budget + governance patterns now. Integrate later if multi-project scale demands it.